

Nonprofit branding: a bibliometric analysis

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Abstract

Purpose – This study aims to examine articles on nonprofit branding over an 18-year time span to develop an overview and better understanding of the subject.

Design/methodology/approach – This study used the Scopus database in a search for studies that deal, regardless of the approach, with branding in a nonprofit context. Subsequently, through a systematic review, a database with 84 articles was generated and 77 articles were submitted to bibliometric analysis.

Findings – This study identified six main research areas (brand and donation, brand management, brand orientation, nonprofit and for-profit partnership, communication strategies and stakeholder management), which were analyzed and discussed, seeking to identify the relationship between research in each area. In addition, this study presents the limitations of the research and thus verify that, although this body of literature is growing, the complexity of the nonprofit sector offers several opportunities for future research, which are pointed out at the end of the study.

Practical implications – This study contributes to the academic literature on the topic by providing a systematization of knowledge about branding in the nonprofit sector and also offers insights about nonprofit branding to institutions and managers in this industry.

Originality/value – This is the first study, to the authors' knowledge, to evaluate and quantify the progress of brand literature in the nonprofit sector.

Keywords Nonprofit sector, Brand management, Bibliometric analysis, Not-for-profit marketing, Nonprofit branding, Brand, Nonprofit

Paper type General review

1. Introduction

The nonprofit landscape has been changing substantially. In the USA, approximately 1.5 million nonprofit organizations were registered with the Internal Revenue Service in 2015, representing an increase of 10.4 per cent in relation to 2005 (National Center for Charitable Statistics, 2019). As the number of nonprofit organizations increases, competition is also intensified (Hopkins *et al.*, 2014). Alongside this, longstanding social organizations already face other challenges, such as a decline in direct donations (Peacock, 2000) and weakening the government and public support and reducing the availability of financial resources (Hibbert and Home, 1996). In face of these challenges, the nonprofit sector has been diversifying its activities, recognizing the importance of becoming more market-driven and using for-profit marketing concepts and values to achieve competitive advantages over competitors (Apaydin, 2011; Ewing and Napoli, 2005). One of these concepts is nonprofit branding.

Despite this, the academy has given little attention to nonprofit branding (Michel and Rieunier, 2012) and for a breakthrough in the study of branding in the nonprofit sector to be achieved, we understand the relevance of examining the current literature to develop an overview and better understanding of the subject. For this reason, this study aims to

analyze the literature dealing with branding in the nonprofit sector, identifying:

- the most frequently addressed themes over time;
- the research methodologies used to conduct the analyzed studies;
- the contributions to the literature made by these articles; and
- verifying any research gaps.

In relation to branding, several marketing concepts, developed in the corporate context, can become a powerful tool for companies operating in the nonprofit sector (Baghi and Gabrielli, 2013; Ritchie *et al.*, 1999). Therefore, similarly to the private sector, which developed and built brands as a way to create and maintain a differential in an increasingly competitive environment, nonprofit organizations are also more likely to adhere to branding efforts (Apaydin, 2011; Stride and Lee, 2007). Besides differentiation, nonprofit branding can be considered a strategic asset, as it builds trust and represents an institution (corporate heritage), with a brand image which can influence an individual's intention to donate (Lee and Davies, 2019; Michaelidou *et al.*, 2015b).

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However, despite the growing importance of brand in the nonprofit sector, and the fact that the theme is drawing the attention and interest of leaders in this sector, branding studies related to nonprofits still receive limited attention by researchers with regard to the complex managerial issues faced by these organizations (Modi and Sahi, 2018). We see the need for research that can validate and amplify the results, proposals and scales already found and developed as well as help develop new knowledge on the subject, considering the relevance of the subject (Boenigk and Becker, 2016; Vallaster and von Wallpach, 2018). In addition, we found no previous study evaluating and quantifying the progress of brand literature in the nonprofit sector.

The present study is justified by its contribution to the nonprofit marketing literature, providing knowledge about branding in the nonprofit sector to the academic community and institutions in this industry. Thus, we consider that this study can play a relevant role in managers' knowledge about the brand, given that brand awareness is gaining importance in the third sector as it expands.

2. Literature review

After conducting a chronological analysis of nonprofit marketing and branding, nonprofit marketing studies were identified as being initially focused on the principles of marketing that could be applied in the nonprofit sector, the influence on increasing donations and the relationship between the nonprofit organization and the donors (Weir and Hibbert, 2000; Bennett and Sargeant, 2005; Ewing and Napoli, 2005). After these, later studies explored the differences between the for-profit and nonprofit sectors, from both the consumer's and organization's point of view, and examined how marketing strategies could be adapted from the for-profit to the nonprofit sector (Aaker et al., 2010; Apaydin, 2011).

These differences paved the way for a range of studies in marketing concepts, mainly related to nonprofit branding such as brand community (Hassay and Peloza, 2009), brand orientation (Apaydin, 2011), brand image (Baghi and Gabrielli, 2013), market orientation (Wymer et al., 2015) and brand authenticity (Wymer and Akbar, 2017), so that, over time, these themes have become prominent in the literature on the subject. However, studies on marketing strategies and nonprofit branding are not exhausted, and themes such as donation and brand image are still catching the attention of many researchers (Boenigk and Becker, 2016; Hommerová and Severová, 2019; Yoo and Drumwright, 2018).

2.1 Marketing in nonprofit organizations

Marketing has gained acceptance among the community of nonprofit professionals (Ewing and Napoli, 2005) and several studies have focused on understanding how marketing principles apply to this sector (Bennett and Sargeant, 2005; Hommerová and Severová, 2019; Hou et al., 2018; Wymer and Akbar, 2017). Also, several concepts have been adapted, such as relationship marketing, which shows that it aids in fundraising because the relationship is a way to differentiate between organizations and give customers an incentive to remain loyal (Weir and Hibbert, 2000). As well, brand community represents the opportunity to develop greater loyalty among donors, foster new ones and attract volunteers

(Hassay and Peloza, 2009) and market orientation, which exposes the importance and consequences of organizations being market-oriented (Wymer et al., 2015).

Much of the current research in nonprofit marketing has focused on applying relationship marketing techniques to build donor engagement with organizations (Arnett et al., 2003; Sundermann, 2018; Ewing and Napoli, 2005; Hassay and Peloza, 2009). Fundraising is another point that receives considerable attention in the literature and is probably one of the most researched facets of marketing and nonprofit management (Bennett and Sargeant, 2005; Dvorakova and Mackova, 2014; Hommerová and Severová, 2019; Yoo and Drumwright, 2018). According to Bennett and Sargeant (2005), success in fundraising is closely linked to the level of market orientation of a nonprofit organization. For example, Yoo and Drumwright (2018) verified that the use of virtual reality in fundraising increases potential donors' feeling of interacting with potential beneficiaries. This interaction between donors and beneficiaries has a positive impact on donation intent. Other similar findings can be seen in Huang and Ku (2016), Katz (2018) and Sevilla (2018).

In fact, there has been considerable interest lately in the operationalization of the marketing concept and the relationship between the market orientation construct and various nonprofit performance measures (Algharabat et al., 2018; Vázquez et al., 2002). Marketing has also contributed to knowledge related to nonprofit competition, particularly in terms of how the concepts of commercial marketing, such as brand authenticity and the organizational brand image, can contribute to the achievement of differentiation and competitive advantage in an uncertain market (Baghi and Gabrielli, 2013; Khan and Ede, 2009; Randle et al., 2013; Wymer and Akbar, 2017).

Despite these advantages, marketing techniques are rarely used in nonprofit organizations (Chad et al., 2013). Several authors suggest that more research is needed to verify and confirm the validity of their studies in the nonprofit sector (Boenigk and Becker, 2016; Huang and Ku, 2016; Vallaster and von Wallpach, 2018). In addition, substantial differences between nonprofit and for-profit organizations, such as the organizational culture and the complexity of clients, indicate the need for more research that explores marketing concepts, especially those related to the study of the brand (Apaydin, 2011). Therefore, we propose that it is important to pay attention not only to the marketing strategies used but also to brand development in the nonprofit sector, given that the development of strong brands is becoming crucial for the survival of these organizations (Chapleo, 2015). Thus, it is understood that this approach requires more in-depth research.

2.2 Nonprofit branding

Nonprofits probably have a lot to gain from adopting the theories and branding models developed for the commercial sector (Ewing and Napoli, 2005). An efficient for-profit brand provides consumers with a guarantee of the quality of the product or service provided, whereas in the non-commercial sector, a strong brand provides donors with more reliability and collateral reducing donation risks (Voeth and Herbst, 2008).

The brand offers the main point of differentiation between competitors, and this is increasingly recognized as key to the success of the nonprofit organization in inter-sectoral and intra-

sectoral competition (Mort *et al.*, 2007). Stride and Lee (2007) argued that nonprofit brand managers generally have to deal with problems in coordinating communication for different customers (such as beneficiaries, supporters and stakeholders) with different needs and developing coherent communication aligned with the organization's mission and values. But, unlike for-profit management, nonprofit brand management should adopt a more malleable approach given the importance of its own values (Stride and Lee, 2007), reflecting the importance of further studies and outlining the differences between managing for-profit and nonprofit brands.

Despite this, many nonprofit organizations still underuse the potential of their brands (Voeth and Herbst, 2008), probably because of some barriers suggested in the literature such as lack of financial resources, a short-term focus, difficulty communicating with stakeholders and a lack of alignment between the organization's image and its identity (Evans *et al.*, 2012; Lee, 2013).

Yet, the literature reports a clear link between this adoption of brand strategies, competitive advantage (Apaydin, 2011; Venable *et al.*, 2005) and the effective use of resources (Chapleo, 2015). Although nonprofits may gain by adopting some practices from commercial brands, several important differences make branding challenging (Chapleo, 2015). For example, the idea of over-commercialization, or the association with a for-profit brand, can damage rather than benefit a nonprofit organization in some cases (Boenigk and Schuchardt, 2015; Toole and Czarnitzki, 2010; Maier *et al.*, 2016).

Given the relevance of the subject and the consequent increase in studies, the role of the nonprofit brand has changed significantly in recent years. In the past, it was considered as a fundraising and communication tool, focusing on design elements such as name and logo. Today, the brand has evolved to the level of a strategic asset, assuming a larger role in the organization and holding the potential to provide internal guidance to staff and volunteers, as well as external guidance to stakeholders (Boenigk and Becker, 2016).

Brand image concept, for example, is relevant in communicating the main values of an organization, because the perception of the brand plays a role in the formation of attitudes and actions among its stakeholders (Durgee, 2016; Huang and Ku, 2016). Brand equity is the end result of the branding strategy, referring to the added brand value of the brand that results from its strength and ability to influence how the consumer thinks, feels and acts in relation to it (Boenigk and Becker, 2016). In this way, Boenigk and Becker (2016) define three dimensions of nonprofit brand equity (nonprofit brand awareness, nonprofit brand trust and nonprofit brand commitment). They also proposed a performance index based on these three dimensions and suggested that nonprofit organizations could use it to drive their brand strategies, in this way strengthening relationships with their stakeholders.

Because of the fragmentation of studies and scarcity of systematic analysis relevant to brand in the nonprofit sector (Chang and Chung, 2016), we perceive that a systematic literature review (SLR) and a bibliometric analysis can present contributions to help systematize the knowledge about the subject. One of the purposes of this type of analysis is to use statistical and mathematical techniques to structure the information and generate clusters and maps so that

the relationships between the data can be highlighted and visualized in a way that facilitates their interpretation (Börner *et al.*, 2003; Pritchard, 1969; Waltman *et al.*, 2010).

3. Methods

To achieve the objectives of the study, two methodological approaches were carried out in sequence: a SLR and a bibliometric analysis. The source used to search for articles for the SLR was the Scopus database, which is considered the largest database of abstracts and references of peer-reviewed scientific literature (Anees-ur-Rehman *et al.*, 2016; Valenzuela *et al.*, 2017; Wang and Waltman, 2016). The bibliometric analysis was performed using the articles from SLR and generated network maps with the aim of facilitating a visualization of the relationships between the proposed elements (Börner *et al.*, 2003; Waltman *et al.*, 2010).

3.1 Systematic literature review

First, we conducted the SLR. It is argued that systematic reviews have become the most reliable form of research review to evaluate extensive literature bases because of the explicit and rigorous methods used (Denyer and Tranfield, 2006). According to Cook (1997), systematic reviews include a clear statement of the purpose of the review, are comprehensive and retrieve relevant research, in addition to having explicit and systematic selection criteria for searching for information, as well as critical appraisal and synthesis of the information selected. The objective of a systematic review is to synthesize a large volume of information from the studies analyzed and thus identify opportunities for future research (Cook *et al.*, 1997; Denyer and Tranfield, 2006; McKibbin, 2006).

In the search engine, we used the terms “brand” and “nonprofit” or “non-profit” or “not-for-profit”, so that brand was combined using the Boolean operator AND with the other three terms that address the nonprofit sector, which were combined using Boolean operator OR. We applied the search to the fields “article title,” “abstract,” and “keywords,” and carried it out in August 2019. Thus, articles that did not have the words “brand” and “nonprofit”, “non-profit,” or “not-for-profit” in the title, abstract, or keywords were not included. After this, the filters “language” (in English only) and “type of study” (articles and reviews) were applied. To cover as many studies of nonprofit branding as possible, we did not apply filters by sector (e.g. charity, health, environmental protection, higher education, etc.), as this would decrease the number of articles and consequently decrease the size of the final database and the findings of the bibliometric analysis.

Initially, we found 293 different articles. After this first selection, we applied the following exclusion criteria:

- The article does not include any technical information such as author, year or abstract.
- It is not fully related to the areas of business, marketing or nonprofit sector.
- It does not deal explicitly with branding in nonprofit organizations, because, in these cases, it is not possible to identify whether the organizations analyzed were for-profit or nonprofit.

So, to be sure, we only considered studies that claimed to be studying the nonprofit sector. After analysis and exclusion from

the sample of articles that fit at least one of the criteria, the final sample consisted of 84 papers. Only then did we summarize each of the articles by completing the fields in the data extraction form, which contain the basic information (author, date of publication), in addition to the synthesis of the study (objective of the study, methodology used, results, conclusion and suggestions for future studies). Thus, we used a complete list of the information later in the analysis of clusters generated by the bibliometric techniques.

3.2 Bibliometrics

We performed the bibliometric analysis using VOSViewer software version 1.6.10 (Van Eck and Waltman, 2010; Waltman et al., 2010), applying the techniques of analysis of co-occurrence of keywords (Callon et al., 1983) and bibliographic coupling (Kessler, 1963).

Co-occurrence observes how often these terms (keywords) appear in the sample and how close the two terms are, that is, how often two distinct keywords appear together in different articles. For this, all the keywords were initially examined and those that were synonymous, such as “brand” and “brands”, were identified and considered as the same keyword (Cobo et al., 2011; Losiewicz et al., 2000). Thereafter, we applied keyword co-occurrence to generate the clustering of the keywords according to their degree of association in the literature.

From another perspective, bibliographic coupling examines the number of references that two articles have in common; that is, if two articles cite a third, then the first two are bibliographically coupled. In addition, the more references they share, the more similar they are (Egghe and Rousseau (2002), Kessler (1963)). Therefore, we suggest that each cluster formed by the application of the bibliographic coupling technique forms the basis of a determined search front because that cluster has articles that share several references (Jarneving, 2005).

The interactions formed by the application of these techniques were illustrated in network maps (Li et al., 2016; Marchiori and Mendes, 2018; Martínez-López et al., 2018), where each map was calculated by measuring the interaction force between terms, taking into account the number of links between the terms (Van Eck and Waltman, 2010; Waltman et al., 2010). Graphically, each node represents a term, which in this case is an article or keyword, depending on the analysis. Therefore, each node belongs to a cluster. In addition, larger nodes represent more relevant terms than smaller nodes, and the closer one node is to another, the more related they are (even if the nodes are in different clusters). Finally, the lines show the links between nodes (Cobo et al., 2011; Sinkovics, 2016; Van Eck and Waltman, 2010).

4. Results

4.1 Keywords

For a better understanding of published studies on branding in the nonprofit sector, as well as the relationship between these studies (Marchiori and Mendes, 2018), we performed an analysis of the co-occurrence of keywords.

For this analysis, we considered the keywords provided by the authors, initially finding a total of 277 keywords. We then

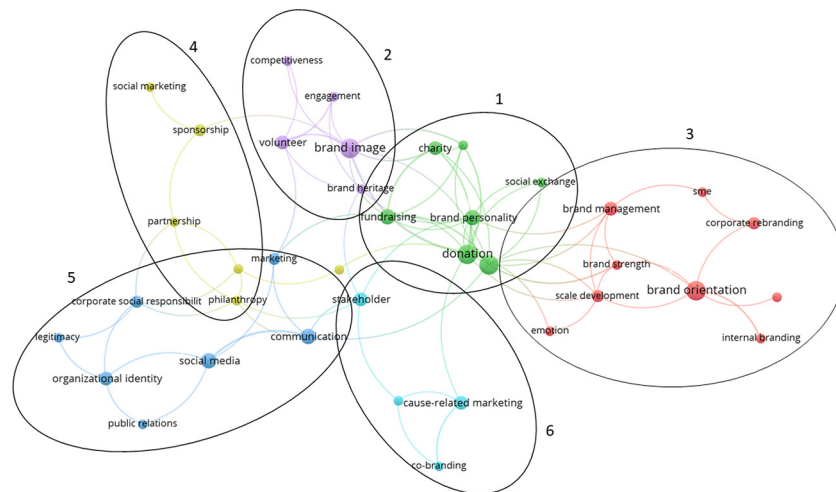
performed an analysis of synonyms where terms such as “nonprofit”, “non-profit” and “not-for-profit” were considered as equal. After the correction, 232 distinct terms were found, of which only 43 occurred two or more times. We also removed the terms “brand”, “branding” and “nonprofit” or synonyms, because the articles were initially selected by the search engine using these keywords. In this manner, of the 40 remaining keywords, we analyzed 38 final keywords, because two keywords had no connection with the others, using a resolution of one and a minimum group size equal to four keywords (approximately 10 per cent of the sample), culminating in the formation of six groups, obtaining a satisfactory level of detail (Waltman et al., 2010). The generated map is shown in Figure 1, and each cluster is circled and numbered to facilitate visualization.

In Group 1, the keywords “nonprofit marketing”, “fundraising”, “donation”, “charity” and “brand personality” appear together. Although the utility of brand personality has been questioned in the literature (Romaniuk and Ehrenberg, 2012), studies such as those by Sargeant et al. (2008a, 2008b) discuss how brand personality manifests differently in the nonprofit sector than in the for-profit sector, and how the different dimensions of brand personality can affect the intention to donate. Furthermore, authors like Venable et al. (2005) identified that “brand personality” contributes to the formation of “brand image”, which affects the donation intention (Huang and Ku, 2016). Michel and Rieunier (2012) showed that there is a positive relationship between the dimensions that integrate nonprofit brand image (NBI) and the intention to donate. The connections between brand personality and brand image, and the intention to donate may explain the proximity of the keyword “brand image” to Group 1, even though it belongs to Group 2.

In addition to “brand image”, Group 2 contains “volunteer”, “engagement” and “brand heritage” as keywords. Randle et al. (2013) conclude that, depending on brand image, nonprofit organizations should adopt competitive strategies or collaborative strategies for the recruitment of volunteers. Furthermore, the brand image also affects volunteers’ engagement in the organization (Curran and Taheri, 2019). Besides that, in their case study, McMullan et al. (2009) analyze the challenge of modernizing the Canadian Armed Forces brand image while preserving the brand values of that organization (brand heritage), comparing with public and nonprofit brands.

On the other hand, Group 3 is related to “brand orientation”, because this is the most relevant term in the grouping (the largest node). The keyword appears to be more related to internal and external brand management and may be related to the need to align internal and external brand management activities because they can play a central role in the success of brand building (Ewing and Napoli, 2005; Khan and Ede, 2009). It is interesting to note that nonprofit brand orientation (NBO) precedes NBI as NBO can be defined as the extent to which a nonprofit organization sees itself as a brand (Hankinson, 2000).

Group 4 is related to partnerships between nonprofit and for-profit organizations, considering that keywords such as “sponsorship”, “partnerships” and “social marketing” are associated with this group. Although partnerships between the

Figure 1 Keywords

Source: Research data

nonprofit and for-profit sectors can bring mutual benefits, they should be looked at carefully and communicated very well to stakeholders. That is because, in some cases, partnerships can bring damage to a nonprofit organization such as a loss of credibility, an overly commercialized image and a decline of its social mission. One way to mitigate the risk of an unsuccessful partnership is by ensuring that the organizations involved (nonprofit and for-profit) hold shared organizational values (Boenigk and Schuchardt, 2015; Herlin, 2015; Jordan, 2018).

Group 5 contains “social media” as the main keyword. It also uses keywords such as “communication”, “public relations” and “organizational identity”. Whereas social media can be used to build brand image and improve the relationship between nonprofit organizations and the target audience, nonprofit brand managers do not fully understand how to use this tool properly. Social media is rarely used, for example, to disseminate information about the organization, to promote sponsors, and to advertise volunteering opportunities, forms of donations, online stores and events calendars (Waters *et al.*, 2009; Eagleman, 2013).

Finally, Group 6 is associated with terms such as “stakeholder”, “cause-related marketing” and “co-branding”, possibly related to the effects of social-cause-related marketing. Studies such as Baghi and Gabrielli (2013) and Thamaraiselvan *et al.* (2017) demonstrate that proper marketing strategies, such as co-branding and celebrity advocacy, can achieve good results for nonprofit organizations, such as increasing brand credibility. On the other hand, Vallaster and von Wallpach (2018) argue that brand strategies are formed by several stakeholders, meaning that the strategy is co-created by several parties involved with the organization and therefore must be aligned among them all (Laidler-Kylander *et al.*, 2007).

4.2 Bibliographic coupling

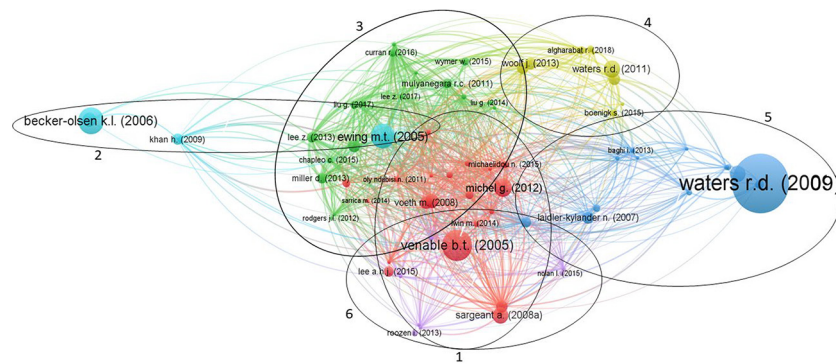
To determine the main research fronts (Jarneving, 2005) and to better understand the contributions, methodologies used and literature gaps within the theme of branding in the nonprofit

sector, we used the bibliographic coupling of documents. Of the 84 articles that formed the database, 77 were bibliographically coupled and were the object of this analysis. The other seven articles did not share any study of their theoretical framework with the references of the selected studies. Therefore, we did not bibliographically couple them and they were removed from the analysis. In addition, a resolution of 0.7 was established, with parameter values of 1 and 0 representing attraction and repulsion, respectively, to achieve a satisfactory level of detail for the analyses (Waltman *et al.*, 2010). With this, the map generated is shown in Figures 2 and 3, where each of the six clusters found is circled for easy visualization. Both Figures 2 and 3 present the same results, but in Figure 3 the lines have been omitted for better visualization.

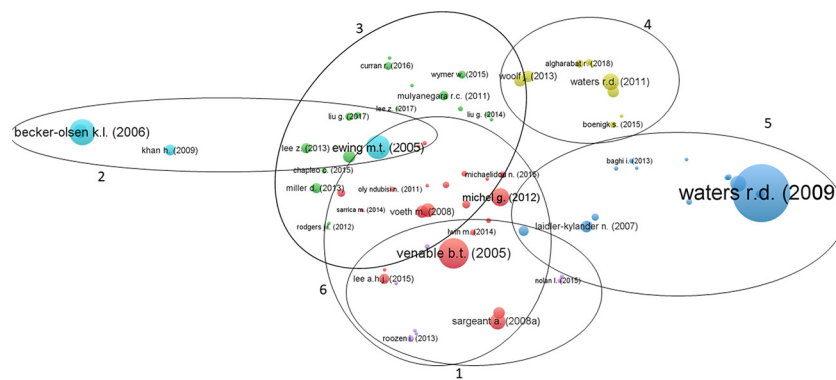
In general, the map has clusters with balanced quantities of articles. In fact, there is not a very significant inequality. However, Clusters 2 and 6 have fewer articles than others. Whereas Cluster 1 has 21 articles, Clusters 3 and 5 have 17 and 16, respectively, and Clusters 2 and 6 have six and seven articles, respectively.

In addition, each cluster was titled according to its main topic, basing this finding on the analysis of its four most cited articles according to the Scopus database. Also, each cluster was related to the main keyword of the keyword group. The results can be seen in Table I. The resulting clusters, with all the articles, are in Appendix.

When analyzing the most cited works within each cluster, Cluster 1 seems to bring together articles that sought to bring knowledge of for-profit industry branding terms such as brand image and brand personality and adapt them to the nonprofit sector, verifying their potentialities, mainly in regards to the distinction of the brand and the impacts on donations. Cluster 2 seems to contain works that discuss the consequences of brand management empirically. Cluster 3 contains, in its most cited articles, studies that advocate the adoption of nonprofit marketing strategies, highlighting those focused on the brand. In general, they deal with conceptual discussions of brand

Figure 2 Bibliographic coupling by articles

Source: Research data

Figure 3 Bibliographic coupling by articles without lines

Source: Research data

orientation, demonstrating the importance of well-defined strategies in the nonprofit sector.

Most of the works in Cluster 4 discuss issues of partnership with for-profit organizations and the effects of these partnerships on donations and nonprofit brand legitimacy. Yet the most cited works in Cluster 5 deal with the promotion and building of the brand through social media and communication in general. In addition, some studies discuss how social media and other media tools are used in cause-related marketing through partnerships between nonprofit and for-profit organizations. Finally, Cluster 6 addresses stakeholder management and how to build nonprofit brand strategies.

5. Discussion

The papers in this review date from the early 2000s to 2019. Thus, over almost 20 years of studies, we identified that brand concerns in the nonprofit sector begin to develop from an organization's worries about communications with its stakeholders and about its reputation (Mitchell and Mitchell, 2001; Padanyi and Gainer, 2003). Then, the research begins to study the adaptation of for-profit brand concepts (such as brand orientation, brand equity and brand personality) in a nonprofit context, developing measurement scales of these concepts for nonprofit organizations (Faircloth, 2005; Venable et al., 2005;

Ewing and Napoli, 2005; Voeth and Herbst, 2008). Going forward, Waters et al. (2009) and Waters and Jones (2011) studied how social media can be used to build nonprofit brands and relationships with stakeholders.

The associations between nonprofit and for-profit organizations are also reported in nonprofit branding literature and the alignment between the mission and the vision of both organizations seems to be a key factor in partnership success (Reeves, 2013). Also, the literature has been discussing the impacts of the brand in donations, and a brand image seems to play an important role in this subject (Katz, 2018; Huang and Ku, 2016; Michaelidou et al., 2019).

The results found in the keyword groups, which denote the relationship between the themes of published studies, are in line with the research avenues found in bibliographic coupling. This shows that the related themes actually form the research avenues found. However, some groups have keywords from more than one cluster, showing that, in some themes, the research avenues are related to each other, which is expected, because the main subject is the same (nonprofit branding). Moreover, there is a concentration of nodes in the center of Figure 2, despite the different clusters, showing that the research is closely related.

In the bibliographic coupling, we can perceive the formation of six clusters named brand and donation, brand management,

Table I Clusters of the bibliographic coupling

Main studies	Main topic	Main keyword	Cluster	No. of citations
Venable <i>et al.</i> (2005)	Brand strategies for donation	Donation	1	145
Michel and Rieunier (2012)			1	53
Sargeant <i>et al.</i> (2008a)			1	40
Faircloth (2005)			1	30
Becker-Olsen and Hill (2006)	Brand management	Brand image	2	107
Ewing and Napoli (2005)			2	94
Vestergaard (2008)			2	31
Khan and Ede (2009)			2	20
Casidy (2014)	Brand orientation	Brand orientation	3	24
Lee (2013)			3	16
Miller and Merrilees (2013)			3	16
Mulyanegara (2011)			3	15
Waters and Jones (2011)	Nonprofit and for-profit partnerships	Partnership	4	45
Woolf <i>et al.</i> (2013)			4	23
Hassay and Peloza (2009)			4	21
Herlin (2015)			4	21
Waters <i>et al.</i> (2009)	Communication strategies	Communication	5	528
Eagleman (2013)			5	40
Laidler-Kylander <i>et al.</i> (2007)			5	23
Mort <i>et al.</i> (2007)			5	18
Roozen (2013)	Stakeholder management	Stakeholder	6	7
Nolan (2015)			6	5
Wymer <i>et al.</i> (2016)			6	5
Vallaster and Von Wallpach (2018)			6	3

Source: Research data

brand orientation, nonprofit and for-profit partnerships, communication strategies and stakeholder management. Additionally, it is possible to note how the research has been developed over time and which topics are catching more attention from academics nowadays.

In the analysis of the first cluster, named brand and donation, the articles were dedicated to studying several concepts in branding, such as brand equity, brand personality and, in particular, brand image, which were previously studied in the for-profit sector and have been adapted to the nonprofit context. In general, articles create scales to validate their studies and attribute the gain of organizational benefits, such as increased donation intentions and increased involvement of volunteers, to the effective adoption of branding techniques (Boenigk and Becker, 2016; Michel and Rieunier, 2012; Sarrica *et al.*, 2014). The studies gathered by this cluster were published between 2005 and 2019. It shows that the relationship between brand and donations has been a recurring topic of interest in academia.

A qualitative study by Faircloth (2005) empirically extended brand equity constructs to the nonprofit sector. After just over a decade, Boenigk and Becker (2016) affirmed that there is still limited research on the concept of brand equity profit. Therefore, in their study, they provide insights into the operationalization of brand equity and of instrumentalizing an initial measurement index of brand equity for the industry, contributing to the discussion on the brand value of nonprofits. The study of one other brand concept, called brand personality, served as the theoretical basis of six studies (Sargeant *et al.*, 2008a, 2008b;

Shehu *et al.*, 2016; Stinnett *et al.*, 2013; Venable *et al.*, 2005; Voeth and Herbst, 2008), mostly qualitative.

Research such as that conducted by Venable *et al.* (2005), Voeth and Herbst (2008) and Sargeant *et al.* (2008a, 2008b), which has addressed the theme in the nonprofit sector, have emphasized the exploration of the applicability of brand personality in nonprofit organizations, investigating its validation and structuring. On the other hand, research that is more recent has brought other approaches related to brand personality. Stinnett *et al.* (2013) devoted their study to individuals' perceptions of the personality of the brand, examining how individuals attribute human characteristics to nonprofits, and Shehu *et al.* (2016) sought to identify how the positive influence of a nonprofit brand personality is adversely affected when monetary incentives are offered to donors. The general conclusion of the authors is that adapting the concept of brand personality in the nonprofit sector should be managed well by leaders of nonprofit organizations; after all, it can affect the image of the organization (Venable *et al.*, 2005).

Brand image was another concept addressed in Cluster 1 studies and these studies sought to relate the brand image to donation intentions. Michel and Rieunier (2012) sought to identify NBI components and to test their influence on donation intentions. In addition, they developed a scale for the NBI that was subsequently investigated in a study by Michaelidou *et al.* (2015a), which aimed to present a better theoretical understanding of the NBI. In the same year, Michaelidou *et al.* (2015b) carried out research that again clarified propositions suggested by Michel and Rieunier (2012). In all three studies, the methodology used was factor

analysis. Huang and Ku (2016), in turn, proposed to examine the concept of brand image in the virtual context. By using the scale proposed by Michel and Rieunier (2012), they concluded that the information provided by a nonprofit organization's website could help create its brand image, again relating it to donation intentions.

It is interesting to note that the relationship between brand image and subjects related to donation and charity is manifested in keyword Groups 1 and 2 (Figure 1). Although the keywords "brand image" and "donation" do not belong to the same keyword group, they are keyword groups located next to each other (Figure 1), demonstrating the proximity of these keywords to Cluster 1 (Figure 2).

Cluster 2, named brand management, links works such as Khan and Ede (2009) and Becker-Olsen and Hill (2006). These studies encourage managers and leaders of nonprofit organizations to apply a management approach to the practice of marketing and branding. To access NBO, Ewing and Napoli (2005) developed a multidimensional scale. They suggested that this scale could be used to guide brand management activities. However, Vestergaard (2008) researched the use of media discourse by humanitarian organizations, discussing how an organization might use the media to create visibility, leveraging this visibility into an increase of recruitment to the cause.

In the same way, Winston (2017) explored, in a case study, a nonprofit organization's placement of symbols or advertising materials in movies and TV shows to promote the organization and its cause. The author argued that brand is managed with the aim of incorporating the organization's cause, in this case, Amnesty International, into society, creating a "human rights culture". Another point highlighted by the author is the difficulty of tracking and measuring the influence of brand display within cultural products (such as movies and TV shows).

Finally, McMullan et al. (2009) related the challenges of brand management for the Canadian Armed Forces. According to the authors, on one hand, it is necessary to keep the traditions and the brand values (brand heritage); on the other hand, the organization also needs to create a brand that is more attractive to young Canadians. Thus, it is possible to verify the relation between Cluster 2 (brand management) and the Group 2 keywords. Except for the study by Winston (2017), this research avenue indicated that this theme was more researched in the first decade of the 2000s, when most of the studies in this cluster were published.

The articles in Cluster 3 (brand orientation) contribute to nonprofit branding research, with the main theme being the understanding and development of the brand. Studies that are part of this cluster indicate that, although the concept of brand orientation began with Urde (1994), brand orientation began to be investigated more frequently and in-depth from the second decade of the 2000s onwards. Therefore, the cluster is formed from qualitative works (Chapleo, 2015; Lee, 2013; Wymer et al., 2015) and studies that used analysis techniques, such as factor analysis, structural equation modeling and various types of linear regressions (Casidy, 2014; Ewing and Napoli, 2005; Liu et al., 2015, 2017; Mulyanegara, 2011). The studies support the literature showing that brand orientation can play a significant role in the development of the activities

and structure of nonprofit organizations, in addition to demonstrating the importance of branding for these organizations, as presented in the theoretical model of antecedents and consequents to brand orientation as suggested by Apaydin (2011). Mulyanegara (2011) adapted the approach of Ewing and Napoli (2005) when studying the perception of brand orientation. Liu et al. (2015, 2017) deepened the understanding of internal branding, suggesting that brand orientation plays a key role in internal brand management. Other strategies appear as well in the works of this cluster. Wymer et al. (2015), for example, conducted a broader study focused on marketing orientation, suggesting that there is a need for more research on the subject. Curran et al. (2016) studied the concept of brand heritage using regression by partial least squares as the method of analysis and concluded that brand heritage plays an important role in increasing volunteer engagement.

Thus, the different approaches in Clusters 2 and 3 are related, as they both discuss the advantages of applying nonprofit brand strategies. Graphically, it is possible to see that the clusters are intertwined in Figure 2. Moreover, many brand strategies and their management are interconnected in keyword Group 2 (Figure 1).

The fourth cluster, entitled nonprofit and for-profit partnerships, is comprised of articles that examine the relationship between the nonprofit brand and stakeholders, including partnerships with the for-profit sector. They seek to analyze the consequence of adopting brand practices and their impact on the relationship of the organization with its target audience. Studies such as the one by Hassay and Peloza (2009) presented the concept of brand community as an opportunity to develop and foster the involvement and identification of donors and volunteers. Woolf et al. (2013) continued the study of the brand community but explored the extent to which a charity event would be able to promote brand engagement with its public, revealing that, in their case study, the charity event had little effect on the participants' relationship with the charity. Events were also investigated in the study by Toledano and Riches (2014), who discussed the potential of a health promotion event to both convey social messages and impact behavior change among the public. They concluded that nonprofits should manage their communication and intervention projects carefully.

In addition, this study addressed an inter-sectoral relationship, as did several other pieces of research present in the cluster (Boenigk and Schuchardt, 2015; Herlin, 2015; Reeves, 2013). As a rule, these studies examined the potential and consequences of adopting strategies such as brand partnerships and cause-related marketing. The results suggest organizational benefits accrue from adopting such practices, emphasizing the need for a strategic adjustment between the sectors. Lastly, Park et al. (2004) studied alignment in advertising and showed a positive reaction in terms of attitude towards the nonprofit organization and donation intention.

The fifth cluster, entitled communication strategies, comprises articles that relate brand strategies of nonprofits with the communication process and also the use of social media. Laidler-Kylander et al. (2007), studying the strategies present in the construction and evaluation of nonprofit brands, concluded that brand plays several critical roles in the

organization, especially in communication with the various stakeholders, as well as playing a key role in fundraising. In addition, they stressed the importance of effective brand communication, pointing out that such communication can be a challenge for leaders of nonprofit organizations. [Torres \(2010\)](#) and [Bebko et al. \(2014\)](#) took a similar approach when examining nonprofit branding and communication strategies, concluding that communication efforts are becoming increasingly important because they play a central role in the positioning and perception of the organization among multiple publics and in the intentions of the donor.

With regard to social media, some studies focused on the virtual environment. In general, these articles contribute to understanding how nonprofit organizations use social media to reach their goals ([Burton et al., 2017](#); [Goldkind, 2015](#); [Waters et al., 2009](#)). [Waters et al. \(2009\)](#) and [Burton et al. \(2017\)](#) stated that these organizations recognize the potential of social media resources but are not using them to their full potential. The study by [Burton et al. \(2017\)](#) stepped up the exploration of the interaction of the nonprofit organization with its partners, evaluating reciprocity within the virtual context and recommending that the partnership should be strategically managed to maximize the benefits of the relationship. [Cooke \(2010\)](#) in turn, explored the tendency toward increased interaction between corporations and non-profit organizations, but outside the virtual context. [Liu \(2012\)](#) focused on communication management and showed that nonprofits are adapting social media tools, providing better brand recognition. Lastly, [Goldkind \(2015\)](#) suggested that the literature on the use of social media in nonprofit organizations is still unsatisfactory.

The importance of social media is reinforced by the work of [Waters et al. \(2009\)](#), the most cited article in our sample. The article is around 10 years old (which helps it to have more citations than more recent works), but despite that, when we analyzed it more closely in the Scopus database, the largest number of citations occurred in 2016. Therefore, the social media theme is not only relevant for nonprofit organizations in communicating with stakeholders; it is also a contemporary issue.

Regarding the relation between the clusters, works such as [Palakshappa et al. \(2010\)](#) and [Park et al. \(2004\)](#) highlight a link between Cluster 4, which deals with nonprofit and for-profit partnerships, and Cluster 5, which deals with communication strategies. Besides that, keyword Groups 4 and 5 ([Figure 1](#)), which have “partnership” and “communication” as their main keywords, respectively, also indicate this relation. These groups appear side by side in [Figure 1](#) and have intersection points, showing that the subjects are interconnected in the literature. Just as Clusters 4 and 5 are related through keywords, the development of these clusters’ subjects also seems to be interconnected. The studies that are in these clusters date back to the early 2000s ([Park et al., 2004](#); [Mort et al., 2007](#)) to the time of this research, and the relationship created by partnerships formed by for-profits and nonprofits seems to advance to discussion of corporate social responsibility and partner companies’ communication alignment, especially via social media, which mutually benefits and strengthens brands on both sides of the partnership ([Algharabat et al., 2018](#); [Burton et al., 2017](#); [Nguyen et al., 2018](#); [Thamaraiselvan et al., 2017](#)).

Finally, Cluster 6, named stakeholder management, is formed by works that follow the literature on stakeholder involvement in processes and structures of nonprofit organizations. For example, [Vallaster and von Wallpach \(2018\)](#) investigated, in a case study, how stakeholders engage with and co-create the brand strategy, recognizing that stakeholders have a strong impact on the co-creation process of the brand strategy and proposing new ways of managing a brand in non-profit contexts. According to [Chad \(2015\)](#), brands communicate with various stakeholders, which suggests that organizations that deliver communication effectively will likely have effective corporate rebranding. [Wymer et al. \(2016\)](#) also related the use of brand concepts to organizational gains, but, in this case, they studied the concept of brand strength. [Wymer et al. \(2016\)](#) considered how this concept relates to the degree to which the organization is favorably perceived by a target group and presented it as an antecedent to the favorable behavioral intentions and intentions regarding the brands of these organizations. This subject seems to be catching the attention of the academy more recently because most of the papers in this cluster vary from 2015 to 2018.

Another link is the relation between Clusters 5 and 6, highlighting the central role of aligning communication between stakeholders in nonprofit organizations ([Laidler-Kylander et al., 2007](#)). This relationship can also be seen graphically in the intersection of Keyword Groups 5 and 6 ([Figure 1](#)) and the proximity of the keywords “communication” (Group 5) and “stakeholder” (Group 6).

In all clusters, there are several contributions to the study of nonprofit brands. However, there is still a need for new research to confirm the perceptions proposed in some studies ([Curran et al., 2016](#); [Vallaster and von Wallpach, 2018](#)), in addition to expanding research for a variety of nonprofit sectors, examining multiple organizations, and conducting such research in other cultures ([Algharabat et al., 2018](#); [Burton et al., 2017](#)). Beyond these limitations, we have identified gaps that can be further explored by researchers in the field, reflecting on practical results for nonprofit organizations.

6. Future research agenda

Because of the development of the theory, many researchers have applied qualitative methods; thus, future research can further explore these findings as well as test the proposed models through quantitative methods. Also, small nonprofit organizations are a relatively understudied area, including in developing economies, where, given their economic condition, there is a great need for social organizations, perhaps even more so than in developed countries ([Ernst et al., 2015](#); [Sheth, 2011](#)). As an example of research gaps, [Garg et al. \(2019\)](#) proposed a metric for brand effectiveness that encompasses the concepts of brand image, brand identity and brand performance. They based their findings on a sample of nonprofit organizations from northern India, but they did not explore the barriers to implementation of this approach in nonprofit organizations.

Briefly, because of the dispersion and fragmentation of research on nonprofit branding, especially as it is considered a recent subject, it is not possible to identify theoretical areas of greater interest, and, based on the six clusters analysis, we

Table II Research opportunities

Main topic	Future research
Brand and donation	Examine the effects of rewards or motivations on intention to donate time, money and/or goods (Michaelidou et al., 2015b; Shehu et al., 2016) Analyze how individuals make choices about donations under the influence of different factors, such as reliability and familiarity, and in different contexts (Katz, 2018) In addition, the use of marketing research can be studied in a nonprofit context
Brand management	Regarding the works that deal with specific strategies and brand concepts in the nonprofit sector, future studies could explore the complexity of rebranding implementation (Lee, 2013) as well as investigating the consequences in practice (Plewa et al., 2011). It would also be relevant to explore those organizations that failed to adopt this strategy (Lee and Bourne, 2017). In addition, it would be interesting to explore employee involvement in the rebranding process (Chad, 2015) Because of the success of different nonprofit brand strategies, which other brand strategies could be applied to the nonprofit sector? Does the strategy require an adaptation from the for-profit sector? In general, it is necessary to carry out research that looks at how brand management can improve the general marketing strategy of the nonprofit organization (Mort et al., 2007; Baghi and Gabrielli, 2013) Also, it would be interesting to find out which types of nonprofit organizations use brand strategies effectively
Brand orientation	Brand orientation, and more precisely the barriers to implementation, seems to be slightly verified. However, this strategy can be considered an antecedent of many other strategies, such as brand engagement and brand equity (Wong and Merrilees, 2005; Zhang et al., 2016), which could be further researched. Liu et al. (2015) suggest developing an integrated internal branding model as well as exploring the effects of brand orientation culture in nonprofit organizations In relation to the nonprofit's brand strength, it can be verified whether it is antecedent to the desired results of marketing (Wymer et al., 2016) Also, future research could discuss the validity of brand concepts in the nonprofit context
Nonprofit and for-profit partnerships	A challenge in partnerships between nonprofit and for-profit organizations seems to be the use of indicators to quantify the gains and returns on both sides. This seems to be more difficult in small and less well-known nonprofit organizations. Having said that, we suggested research that seeks to understand the motivations of these partnerships and how the brand impacts this partnership process For-profit organizations have been increasingly concerned about social responsibility and sustainability. One suggestion is that this concern can positively influence the partnership relations between nonprofit and for-profit organizations, increasing the interest of for-profit organizations in looking for partnerships It might be interesting to look how closely corporate foundations share brand image with their corporate brothers. For instance, how does the brand image of the firm foundation differ from firm itself
Communication strategies	In the virtual context, there is a need to investigate the antecedents and consequents of the implementation of social media at the nonprofit organizational level (Goldkind, 2015) as well as the creation of new online branding communications (Chapleo, 2015) Studies can further investigate how the information provided by the website contributes to the nonprofit's brand image (Huang and Ku, 2016). In addition, it is recommended that studies and their propositions be tested on different social media platforms (Burton et al., 2017; Algharabat et al., 2018) It is important to investigate the emphasis on advertising campaigns, mainly to create a brand image. That is, does the communication in nonprofit organizations aim to raise awareness of the cause or to increase donations? Is it better to use an appealing tone linked to the problem that the nonprofit organization seeks to minimize or to show the reality benefited by that nonprofit organization? (Vestergaard, 2008) More research on the use of brand promotion channels, such as social media, and advertisements on various vehicles, can be useful for brand development in nonprofit organizations, a strategy that can contribute significantly to the performance of this type of organization A challenge is how to deliver effective communication that can support the nonprofit brand through social media marketing, online marketing and traditional marketing (Chapleo, 2015) It should be noted how social media is currently used in nonprofit organizations to disseminate information about the organization, to promote sponsors and to advertise volunteering opportunities, forms of donations, online stores and events calendars
Stakeholder management	The main nonprofit organizations' stakeholders used to be the donors and beneficiaries. However, it would be interesting to investigate the relation between these groups of stakeholders, for example, to verify whether testimonials or actions that materialize the benefits achieved by the nonprofit organization for the beneficiaries can improve the intention to donate time, money and/or goods (Yoo and Drumwright, 2018) It would be interesting to investigate, based on financial measures, the impact of the use of brand strategies on stakeholders to create empirical and quantifiable evidence of the benefits pointed out in the literature, especially financial (such as marketing share, ROI), which is an important argument to many stakeholders. Indeed, performance indicators seem to be little explored in nonprofit organizations, although they are widely used in for-profit sectors

Source: Own elaboration

observed a range of opportunities to conduct more research, but we did not observe any subject that may be considered exhausted. As an example, although the relationship between brand and donations has been widely explored over time, there are still gaps such as how the different external factors influence the intention to donate, and the motivations that lead to different types of donation such as time, goods and money (Katz, 2018; Michaelidou et al., 2015b; Shehu et al., 2016). Even the brand management cluster, which gathers fewer current studies, also brings research opportunities such as the barriers and consequences of rebranding in nonprofit organizations (Lee, 2013; Plewa et al., 2011). In addition to the limitations of clusters, it would even be interesting to note which types of organizations (such as arts, culture, human rights, education, research, environmental, animal, health, human services, international issues, foreign affairs, public issues, societal benefit, religious and mutual/membership benefit) are further studied or which derive more benefits within the theme of nonprofit branding. In short, the identified possibilities to nonprofit branding research based on each cluster were summarized in Table II.

Several studies have very specific limitations, such as geographic and cultural ones (Algharabat et al., 2018; Bebko et al., 2014; Herlin, 2015; Huang and Ku, 2016; Katz, 2018; Liu et al., 2017; Maier, 2016; Michaelidou et al., 2015a; Shehu et al., 2016) because most articles focus on the USA, the UK, Canada and Australia. In view of the above, it would be interesting to understand the relevant differences and preferences of studies in the USA and UK, for example. Another obstacle in carrying out several works was the impossibility of generalizing the results proposed because they have a limited sample and are restricted to certain nonprofit contexts (Casidy, 2014; Chad, 2015; Durgee, 2016; Herlin, 2015; Huang and Ku, 2016; Maier, 2016; Michaelidou et al., 2015a, 2015b; Plewa et al., 2011; Shehu et al., 2016). Also, several authors have suggested verifying the validation of their results, such as the proposed scales (Vallaster and von Wallpach, 2018; Boenigk and Becker, 2016; Curran et al., 2016; Wymer et al., 2015; Liu et al., 2014; Apaydin, 2011; Hassay and Pelloza, 2009).

7. Conclusion

In conclusion, the size and complexity of the nonprofit sector result in studies that are unlikely to be representative of all nonprofits (Lee and Bourne, 2017). Thus, as a main theoretical contribution, the study identified six research avenues in nonprofit branding that emerge from our data, named brand and donation, brand management, brand orientation, nonprofit and for-profit partnerships, communication strategies and stakeholder management. The development of each research avenue was analyzed, and a future research agenda was proposed.

Beyond the theoretical contributions, each cluster also brings practical contributions as the brand concepts (such as brand image and brand personality) and how it can affect donations (positively or not); the importance of brand management to persuade people to join the cause; the evidence that brand orientation can support the development of activities and structure of nonprofit organizations; brand practices to support

and build mutually beneficial partnerships between nonprofit and for-profit companies; the impacts of communication, with a special focus on social media and stakeholder in building nonprofit brands.

We had noticed that, despite the peculiarities of each research avenue, it is necessary to take into account the existing cultural diversification among countries, in addition to the difference between the various nonprofit sectors, which have many different causes and sizes. Also, the research is concentrated in a few countries, as previously mentioned, which results in a range of opportunities. Finally, we realize that the researches could be more aligned with the practical decisions of nonprofit managers by giving more attention to indicators that highlight the gains generated by investing in nonprofit branding strategies.

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Further reading

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Appendix

Table AI Articles per cluster (sorted by quantity of articles)

No.	Authors	Title	Cluster	No. of citations
1	Venable <i>et al.</i> (2005)	The role of brand personality in charitable giving: an assessment and validation	1	145
2	Michel and Rieunier (2012)	Nonprofit brand image and typicality influences on charitable giving		53
3	Sargeant <i>et al.</i> (2008a)	Charity brand personality: the relationship with giving behavior		40
4	Faircloth (2005)	Factors influencing nonprofit resource provider support decisions: applying the brand equity concept to nonprofits		30
5	Voeth and Herbst (2008)	The concept of brand personality as an instrument for advanced non-profit branding – an empirical analysis		24
6	Sargeant <i>et al.</i> (2008b)	Conceptualizing brand values in the charity sector: the relationship between sector, cause and organization		22
7	Lee <i>et al.</i> (2015)	Creative food clusters and rural development through place branding: culinary tourism initiatives in Stratford and Muskoka, Ontario, Canada		16
8	Hankinson <i>et al.</i> (2007)	The time factor in re-branding organizations: its effects on staff knowledge, attitudes and behaviour in UK charities		10
9	Huang and Ku (2016)	Brand image management for nonprofit organizations: exploring the relationships between websites, brand images and donations		10
10	Stinnett <i>et al.</i> (2013)	Who are we? The impacts of anthropomorphism and the humanization of nonprofits on brand personality		8
11	Michaelidou <i>et al.</i> (2015a)	An evaluation of nonprofit brand image: towards a better conceptualization and measurement		7
12	Lwin and Phau (2014)	An exploratory study of existential guilt appeals in charitable advertisements		6
13	Shehu <i>et al.</i> (2016)	The brand personality of nonprofit organizations and the influence of monetary incentives		6
14	Michaelidou <i>et al.</i> (2015b)	Consumers' intention to donate to two children's charity brands: a comparison of Barnardo's and BBC Children in Need		5
15	Plewa <i>et al.</i> (2011)	The impact of rebranding on club member relationships		5
16	Boenigk and Becker (2016)	Toward the importance of nonprofit brand equity: results from a study of German nonprofit organizations		3
17	Sarrica <i>et al.</i> (2014)	Employer branding in nonprofit organizations. an exploration of factors that are related to attractiveness, identification with the organization, and promotion: the case of emergency		1
18	Katz (2018)	The impact of familiarity and perceived trustworthiness and influence on donations to nonprofits: an unaided recall study		0
19	Kleinschafer <i>et al.</i> (2018)	The importance of the service encounter in influencing identity salience and volunteering behavior in the cultural sector		0
20	Lithopoulos <i>et al.</i> (2018)	Examining the ParticipACTION brand using the brand equity pyramid		0
21	Michaelidou <i>et al.</i> (2019)	Does non-profit brand image mean the same across cultures? an exploratory evaluation of non-profit brand image in three countries		0
22	Casidy (2014)	Linking brand orientation with service quality, satisfaction, and positive word-of-mouth: evidence from the higher education sector	3	24
23	Lee (2013)	Rebranding in brand-oriented organisations: exploring tensions in the nonprofit sector		16
24	Miller and Merrilees (2013)	Rebuilding community corporate brands: a total stakeholder involvement approach		16
25	Mulyanegara (2011)	The relationship between market orientation, brand orientation and perceived benefits in the non-profit sector: a customer-perceived paradigm		15
26	Curran <i>et al.</i> (2016)	Nonprofit brand heritage: its ability to influence volunteer retention, engagement, and satisfaction		11
27	Liu <i>et al.</i> (2017)	Managing employee attention and internal branding		10
28	Wymer <i>et al.</i> (2015)	The conceptualization of nonprofit marketing orientation: a critical reflection and contributions toward closing the practice–theory gap		10
29	Liu <i>et al.</i> (2015)	The role of internal branding in nonprofit brand management: an empirical investigation		7
30	Chapleo (2015)	Brand 'infrastructure' in nonprofit organizations: challenges to successful brand building?		6

(continued)

Table AI

No.	Authors	Title	Cluster	No. of citations
31	Liu et al. (2014)	Managing branding and legitimacy: a study of charity retail sector		5
32	Apaydin (2011)	A proposed model of antecedents and outcomes of brand orientation for nonprofit sector		4
33	Lee and Bourne (2017)	Managing dual identities in nonprofit rebranding: an exploratory study		2
34	Rodgers and Jackson (2012)	Are we who we think we are: evaluating brand promise at a liberal-arts institution		2
35	Curran and Taheri (2019)	Enhancing volunteer experiences: using communitas to improve engagement and commitment		1
36	Maier (2016)	Beyond branding: Van Riel and Fombrun's corporate communication theory in the human services sector		1
37	Wymer and Akbar (2017)	Brand authenticity, its conceptualization, and its relevance to nonprofit marketing		1
38	Garg et al. (2019)	Branding effectiveness measurement in non-profit environment		0
39	Waters et al. (2009)	Engaging stakeholders through social networking: how nonprofit organizations are using Facebook	5	528
40	Eagleman (2013)	Acceptance, motivations, and usage of social media as a marketing communications tool amongst employees of sport national governing bodies		40
41	Laidler-Kylander et al. (2007)	Building and valuing global brands in the nonprofit sector		23
42	Mort et al. (2007)	Branding in the non-profit context: the case of Surf Life Saving Australia		18
43	Goldkind (2015)	Social media and social service: are nonprofits plugged in to the digital age?		12
44	Bebko et al. (2014)	Using eye tracking to assess the impact of advertising appeals on donor behavior		9
45	Liu (2012)	Toward a better understanding of nonprofit communication management		7
46	Cooke (2010)	Building social capital through corporate social investment		6
47	Randle et al. (2013)	Competition or collaboration? The effect of non-profit brand image on volunteer recruitment strategy		6
48	Burton et al. (2017)	Helping those who help us: co-branded and co-created twitter promotion in CSR partnerships		5
49	Baghi and Gabrielli (2013)	Co-branded cause-related marketing campaigns: the importance of linking two strong brands		4
50	Thamaraiselvan et al. (2017)	Role of celebrity in cause related marketing		3
51	Palakshappa et al. (2010)	Integrated strategic partnerships between business and not-for-profit organisations: a case study from New Zealand		2
52	Torres (2010)	International Committee of the Red Cross: emblems of humanity		1
53	Domański (2011)	The analysis and synthesis of strategic management research in the third sector from early 2000 through to mid-2009		0
54	Nguyen et al. (2018)	Does an expanded brand user base of co-branded advertising help ad-memorability?		0
55	Waters and Jones (2011)	Using video to build an organization's identity and brand: a content analysis of nonprofit organizations' YouTube videos	4	45
56	Woolf et al. (2013)	Do charity sport events function as "brandfests" in the development of brand community?		23
57	Hassay and Pelozo (2009)	Building the charity brand community		21
58	Herlin (2015)	Better safe than sorry: nonprofit organizational legitimacy and cross-sector partnerships		21
59	Algharabat et al. (2018)	The effect of telepresence, social presence and involvement on consumer brand engagement: an empirical study of non-profit organizations		11
60	Boenigk and Schuchardt (2015)	Nonprofit collaboration with luxury brands: positive and negative effects for cause-related marketing		7
61	Park et al. (2004)	The effects of brand familiarity in alignment advertising		7
62	Toledano and Riches (2014)	Brand alliance and event management for social causes: evidence from New Zealand		3
63	Lloyd and Woodside (2015)	Advancing paradox resolution theory for interpreting non-profit, commercial, entrepreneurial strategies		2
64	Reeves (2013)	Brand partnerships as joint ventures: a comparison of two partnerships in the small non-profit arena		0
65	Roozen (2013)	The impact of emotional appeal and the media context on the effectiveness of commercials for not-for-profit and for-profit brands	6	7

(continued)

Table AI

No.	Authors	Title	Cluster	No. of citations
66	Nolan (2015)	The impact of executive personal branding on non-profit perception and communications		5
67	Wymer et al. (2016)	Nonprofit brand strength: What is it? How is it measured? What are its outcomes?		5
68	Vallaster and Von Wallpach (2018)	Brand strategy co-creation in a nonprofit context: a strategy-as-practice approach		3
69	Chad (2015)	Utilising a change management perspective to examine the implementation of corporate rebranding in a non-profit SME		1
70	Durgee (2016)	Exploring what nonprofit branding can learn from contemporary art		0
71	Halbert and Mcdowell (2013)	Sustaining local radio journalism: a case study of the WLRN/ <i>Miami Herald</i> strategic alliance		0
72	Becker-Olsen and Hill (2006)	The impact of sponsor fit on brand equity: the case of nonprofit service providers	2	107
73	Ewing and Napoli (2005)	Developing and validating a multidimensional nonprofit brand orientation scale		94
74	Vestergaard (2008)	The case of Amnesty International		31
75	Khan and Ede (2009)	How do not-for-profit SMEs attempt to develop a strong brand in an increasingly saturated market?		20
76	Mcmullan et al. (2009)	Selling the Canadian Forces' brand to Canada's youth		2
77	Winston (2017)	Nonprofit product placement: human rights advocacy in film and television		2

Source: Research data

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